

# Robert J. Roy

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## Education

Ph.D. Student in Psychology, Present. University of Nebraska-Lincoln, Lincoln, NE.

Discipline: Neuroscience and Behavior

GPA: 4.00

Master of Science, May 2020. Saint Joseph's University, Philadelphia, PA.

Experimental Psychology

GPA: 4.00

Bachelor of Arts, *Magna Cum Laude*, May 2019. Saint Joseph's University, Philadelphia, PA.

Majors in English and Psychology

Minor in Behavioral Neuroscience

GPA: 3.78

## Research and Professional Experience

### *Graduate Student Researcher*

NeuroCognitive Translation Lab, University of Nebraska-Lincoln (2023 – Present)

Principle Investigator: Dr. Nicholas Hubbard

- Conducted research visits for a large fMRI study on methamphetamine use
- Wrote scripts for imaging and analysis workflows
- Instituted a REDCap database system for the methamphetamine study
- Reviewed literature to generate new research ideas
- Prepared drafts for publication
- Completed statistical analyses for publications

Becker Neuroendocrinology Lab, Saint Joseph's University (2019 - 2021)

Principle Investigator: Dr. Elizabeth Becker

Master of Science Thesis: Pair bond formation in the California mouse

- Conducted a behavioral assay to measure pair bond formation
- Collected brains via transcardial perfusion, peripheral blood, and vaginal cell samples for cell quantification
- Organized and analyzed behavioral data collected from experimentation
- Recruited and supervised a team of graduate and undergraduate students to aid with testing

### *Clinical Research Coordinator II*

Early Psychosis Intervention Clinic, Tulane School of Medicine (2021- Present)

Clinic Directors: Dr. Ashely Weiss & Dr. Serena Chaudhry

- Implemented NIMH funded R34 grant by establishing the CSC-ONE Learning Health System as part of clinic workflow as well as conduct the study “Comparison of Coordinated Specialty Care Delivered through Telehealth and Clinic-Based Models: A Pilot Study”
- Obtained IRB approval for a continues chart review study allowing for all clinic data to be used for research purposes
- Created a master REDCap database for clinic data to be used in research by the clinic, medical students, and graduate students
- Coordinated training for clinical staff and student researchers for use of R34 clinical tools for clinical use and research purposes
- Conducted a study on the long-term effects of telehealth during the COVID-19 pandemic
- Published a literature review on the absence of contemporary treatment models for psychosis in social work journals
- Provided editing, guidance, and data analysis on manuscripts in preparation for publication

Louisiana Clinical and Translational Sciences Center, Tulane School of Medicine (2020 - 2021)

Supervisor: Elvia Haynes

- Recruited patients through various cold-contact methods to participate in Janssen’s Phase III Covid-19 vaccine study
- Collected relevant medical history and vitals to determine eligibility for study
- Assisted patients on training and completing eDiary entries for symptom monitoring
- Processed blood, saliva, and nasal swab samples for local and central lab analysis
- Entered PHI into digital system for sponsor review

### *Summer Scholar*

Becker Neuroendocrinology Lab, Saint Joseph’s University (Summers 2018, 2019)

Project Topic: Mating practices of the California mouse

- Awarded a stipend to conduct independent research over the summer for presentation
- Formulated and executed research project as head of a team of researchers
- Interpreted data into meaningful results for presentation to faculty and sponsors
- Presented data at scientific seminars for review and discussion with peers in various scientific fields

### *Undergraduate Research Assistant*

Becker Neuroendocrinology Lab, Saint Joseph's University (2016 – 2019)

Principle Investigator: Dr. Elizabeth Becker

- Assisted in graduate research projects covering an array of behavioral and tissue assays
- Managed a large colony of rodents to ensure animal well-being and compliance with federal standards
- Collected data on operationalized behaviors for statistical analysis
- Weaned rodent offspring into appropriate cages within a time sensitive period

### *Lab Manager*

Becker Neuroendocrinology Lab, Saint Joseph's University (2017 - 2018)

Principle Investigator: Dr. Elizabeth Becker

- Maintained lab functionality through keeping materials regularly supplied
- Integrated and trained new lab members in ethics and basic animal handling
- Documented mouse colony population levels for experimental use

### **Scientific Publications**

#### *In Print*

Schwarb, H., **Roy, R.J.**, Shaefer, AL., Blair RJR., & Hubbard NA. (2025). Sex-dependent hippocampal atrophy among people with methamphetamine-use experience.

Weiss, A., Chaudhry, S., Atiya, W., Long, S., **Roy, R.**, & Mojtabai, R. (2025). Reducing duration of untreated psychosis: Strengthening the case for early detection campaigns. *Psychiatric Services*, 00–00. <https://doi.org/10.1176/appi.ps.20240061>

**Roy, R.**, Hammerdahl, E., Sage, A. and Becker, E.A. (2025), Mating May Enhance Rapid Formation of Stable Pair Bonds in the Monogamous California Mouse. *Ethology* e13545. <https://doi.org/10.1111/eth.13545>

**Roy RJ**, Parvaz MA, Wakabayashi KT, Blair RJR, Hubbard NA. Methamphetamine-related working memory difficulties underpinned by reduced frontoparietal responses. *Addiction Biology*. 2024; 29(10): 1-13. doi:10.1111/adb.13444

Chaudhry, S., **Roy, R.**, Mansourian, K., Weiss, A., Breier, A. (2023). Psychosis, Telehealth, and COVID-19: Engagement and Hospitalization Pre and Peri- Pandemic. *Disaster Medicine and Public Health Preparedness*, 1 – 6. <https://doi.org/10.1017/dmp.2023.144>

Chaudhry, S., **Roy, R.**, Weiss, A., & Hansel, T. (2022). A systematic review of psychosis in social work literature. *Social Work in Mental Health*, 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15332985.2022.2029667>

Valentino, A., **Roy, R.**, & Becker, E. A. (2021). Reproductive success diminished following mate loss for females but not males in a monogamous rodent. *Behavioural Processes*, 188. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.beproc.2021.104415>

*In Prep*

**Roy, R.J.**, Decker, A.L., & Hubbard N.A. (*In prep*). Reward tracking predicts choice behavior in people who use methamphetamine.

*Reviews*

Ming M., Tiancheng Y., Zhi Q., Peng Z., Mudi Z., Jianye G., Ningqing H., Mengqian L., Kaixi Z., Qian C., Jianhuai C., & Guoxiang W. (*In prep*) Abnormal regional brain activity associated with relapse in early abstinent methamphetamine-dependent individuals.

### **Teaching Experience**

*Behavioral Neuroscience Teaching Assistant*

Psychology Department, Saint Joseph's University (Spring 2019) Instructor:

Dr. Elizabeth Becker

- Mentored undergraduates in animal care and behavioral testing
- Provided guidance and insight into designing an experiment
- Supervised and graded undergraduate surgical techniques and writing abilities
- Presented on microscopy in behavioral neuroscience

*Writing Center Tutor*

The Writing Center, Saint Joseph's University (2016- 2020)

Director: Dr. Jenifer Spinner

- Worked with members of the Saint Joseph's University to develop their writing abilities
- Assisted non-native English speakers in writing papers in English
- Ensured accurate usage of various citation styles in accordance with assignment outlines
- Performed independent research on privilege awareness to apply to staff training

### **Scholarly Presentations**

Atiya, W., Chaudhry, S., Weiss, A., Roy, R., Long, S., MD. In search of an evidence based practice to reduce the duration of untreated psychosis.

***International Early Psychosis Association 14<sup>th</sup> Conference, Summer 2023***

Greene, S., Yee, A., Roy, R., Weiss, A., Chaudhry, S., DSW, LCSW, MPH. Hospitalization and Help-Seeking in First Episode Psychosis.

***National Medical Association 2023 Annual Convention and Scientific Assembly, Summer 2023***

**Roy, R.**, Hammerdahl, E., Becker, E. PhD. Pair Bond Formation in the California Mouse.

***Eastern Psychological Association Annual Conference, Virtual Conference, Spring 2021***  
***Society for Behavioral Neuroendocrinology Virtual Conference, Summer 2021***

**Roy, R.,** Dupuis, M., Forbes, J., Sallard, G. Latency and neurochemistry of pair bond formation in the California mouse.

***Summer Scholars Brown Bag Seminar, Saint Joseph's University, Summer 2018***  
***Summer Scholars Symposium, Saint Joseph's University, Fall 2018 Celebration of Student Achievement, Saint Joseph's University, Spring 2019***

Valentino, A., Roy, R. Re-pairing Effects on Birth Latency in the California Mouse.  
***Summer Scholars Brown Bag Seminar, Saint Joseph's University, Summer, 2019***

**Roy, R.,** Rolle, D. Integration of a privilege walk in writing center staff training.  
***National Conference on Peer Tutoring in Writing, Fall 2017***

### **Grants and Funding**

Sigma Xi Research Grant for \$300, Spring 2020

*Project: Factors Contributing to the Formation of Pair Bonds in the California Mouse*

Sigma Xi Research Grant for \$500, Spring 2019

*Project: Factors Contributing to the Formation of Pair Bonds in the California Mouse*

Dean's Travel Award, Saint Joseph's University for \$245, Fall 2017

### **Invited Talks**

Becker Lab Alumni Panel (April, 2024)

NISBRE Graduate School Panel (June, 2024)

### **Honors and Awards**

Othmer Fellow, University of Nebraska-Lincoln, 2023-2026

B.A. awarded with Honors, *Magna Cum Laude*, St. Joseph's University, 2019

Academic Achievement Scholarship, Saint Joseph's University, 2015- 2019

Dean's List, Saint Joseph's University, 2015- 2020

Saint Joseph's University Dean's Travel Award, 2017

Boy Scouts of America Eagle Scout Award, 2013

### **Skills and Qualifications**

*Preclinical*

- Behavioral assays

- Brain collection by rapid decapitation

- CITI certification in aseptic surgical techniques
- Brain collection by transcardial perfusion
- CITI certification in rodent and human research
- Data analysis using SPSS and R
- Data manipulation and organization
- Experimental design
- Immunofluorescence
- Intraperitoneal & sub-cutaneous injections
- Laboratory management
- Light microscopy
- Literature review
- Manuscript preparation
- Microsoft office software
- Protocol creation and implementation
- Pup weaning in rodents
- Retroorbital eye bleed
- Rodent brain sectioning (Cryostat) and preservation
- Rodent care and husbandry
- Scientific presentations
- Stereotaxic surgery using rodents
- Vaginal lavaging in rodents
- Creating Bash scripts

### *Clinical*

- Clinical assessments
- eDiary proficiency (ePRO, eCRF, eCOA)
- IRB submissions
- Minor safety certified
- NIMH data reports
- Obtain informed consent
- Participant recruitment
- Patient medical history
- Patient medical record organization
- Patient vital signs
- REDCap databases
- Self-Report assessments

### Coding & Programming

- R & R studio
- Bash
- AFNI

### **Professional Affiliations**

- WPATH
- Society for Neuroscience
- Society for Behavioral Neuroendocrinology
- Sigma Xi Research Honor Society
- Psi Chi Psychology Honor Society
- Eastern Psychological Association

- Sigma Tau Delta English Honor Society

**Service**

- Brain Awareness Day at Saint Joseph's University (2018)
- Teens Write (2019)